

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

Middle School | Unit 5

Suffix -ic



Today I am learning that the suffix **-ic** often forms an adjective meaning *relating to, characterised by, or having the qualities of* something.

1 Learn the Meaning

The suffix **-ic** commonly forms **adjectives**. These words often mean **relating to, characterised by, or having the qualities of** the base or related word.

atomic

relating to atoms

heroic

showing hero qualities

artistic

relating to art

poetic

having poetic qualities

2 Build the Word

Add **-ic** to the base or related word. Read the new adjective and explain what it describes.

Base / related	Suffix	New word	What it describes
atom	-ic		
artist	-ic		
hero	-ic		
poet	-ic		
symbol	-ic		

3 Read and Notice

Read the passage below.

The local museum opened a new exhibition linking art, history and science. One room explored **atomic** research and explained how tiny particles can affect the physical world. Another displayed **artistic** designs inspired by scientific images and mathematical patterns. A large mural used **symbolic** shapes to represent discovery, while a short **poetic** text described the curiosity of early researchers. The guide also told a **heroic** story about people who protected important records during a flood. In the final gallery, visitors compared **historic** inventions with modern technology and listened to a **rhythmic** sound installation created from recorded machine noises. Maya noticed that many of the describing words ended in **-ic**. She could connect several directly to a base or related word: atom + ic = atomic, artist + ic = artistic and hero + ic = heroic. Other words, such as historic, still showed the same adjective-forming pattern even when the related word changed spelling.



Highlight the **-ic** words. Underline the **base or related word** when you can identify one.

4 Word Detective

Choose one **-ic** word from the passage and investigate its structure and meaning.

- Write an **-ic** word from the passage.

- What **base or related word** can you identify?

- What does the adjective mean in this context?

- Write a word sum or explain how **-ic** shapes the meaning.

5 Sort the Words

Sort the **-ic** words by the kind of meaning they express.

atomic

historic

economic

geographic

heroic

artistic

poetic

rhythmic

Relates to a subject / thing

Shows a quality / style

6 Use It in Writing



Complete the sentence starters.

- A heroic action can _____

- Use an **-ic** adjective in your own sentence.



Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Recognises the suffix **-ic**
- ☐ Finds a base or related word
- ☐ Explains the adjective meaning
- ☐ Spells and uses derived words



Capture idea:

Find an **-ic** word in a book, article or information text. Record its base or related word and explain what the adjective describes.